Matthew McKay, Ph.D.

First 90 days: Director of Learning Operations (LIB-44)

Purpose: a 90-day plan for a new Director of Learning Operations. It shows how I'd diagnose, set priorities, build trust and deliver early results, and it's the kind of plan I'd share with a hiring manager or new team.

Written for Tessaly Health, a fictional nonprofit health system of about 4,000 staff. Situations referenced are from the synthetic case studies on this site. Appendix: one-year learning analytics roadmap (LIB-48).

The situation I'd be walking into

- One enterprise LMS, a nightly HR feed, a data warehouse and a BI tool.
- An executive compliance scorecard that leaders read monthly, plus 21 other recurring reports.
- High first-year turnover in nursing, a first-year nurse residency, and about $6.8 million a year in agency nursing.
- A small learning operations team: LMS administration, reporting, and coordination of instructor-led sessions.

I'd assume nothing in that list is broken until I've seen it, and nothing in it is fine just because nobody has complained.

Days 1–30: listen and diagnose

Goal: understand how learning work actually gets done here, and where the numbers come from.

Activity	With whom	Output
One-on-ones with each team member: their work, what's stuck, what they'd fix first	The team	Team map: roles, workload, skills, frustrations
Meetings with the main customers: compliance, nursing education, HR, finance, two facility leaders	Stakeholders	A list of what each needs from learning operations, in their words
Trace the executive compliance scorecard from the HR system to the BI tool	Reporting lead, data team	A one-page lineage with the controls that exist and the ones that don't
Run a data-quality baseline: duplicate accounts, orphaned enrollments, courses with no owner	LMS administrators	A list of issues by severity; no fixes yet unless something is urgent
Inventory the recurring reports and who opens them	Reporting lead	Report list with owners and usage
Read the last two cycles of compliance results and any audit findings	Compliance	What's been promised to whom

What I won't do in month one: change the scorecard, reorganize the team, or start a platform project.

Days 31–60: set priorities and agree on them

Goal: turn what I found into a short list that the team and stakeholders agree with.

- **Share the diagnosis** with my manager and the team, plainly: what's working, what isn't, and what I don't know yet.
- **Pick three priorities**, each with an owner, a measure and a 90-day milestone. At Tessaly, from the case studies, they would likely be: 1. **One definition of "compliant."** Draft the metric definition sheet (LIB-01) with the compliance office, and show the gap between today's number and the governed one before anyone else finds it. 2. **Controls before the scorecard ships.** A freshness check on the HR feed, a reconciliation to source, and a population check, run before each monthly release (case study D). 3. **Onboarding as a retention lever.** Agree a measurement plan for the onboarding redesign before it launches (LIB-17).
- **Agree what we'll stop.** Retire duplicate and unused reports (LIB-51), and say no, in writing, to new requests that don't fit the priorities this quarter.
- **Set up the team's working rhythm:** a weekly intake review, a monthly data-quality review, and a single list of work in progress that anyone can see.

Days 61–90: deliver and set the operating rhythm

Goal: visible results that prove the approach, and routines that outlast the 90 days.

Early win	Why it matters	Done when
Governed compliance number published beside the old one, with a one-line explanation	Leaders get a number they can defend	Definition v1.0 approved by the compliance office; first release out
Pre-publication checks running on the scorecard	Bad months stop reaching executives	Checks run for two consecutive releases
Access review completed and leaver access fixed	Closes a privacy exposure fast	Findings fixed; quarterly review on the calendar
Report estate cut roughly in half	Frees team time; fewer conflicting numbers	Retirements and merges released
Onboarding measurement plan signed off	The next program is judged on evidence	Decision rules agreed by HR and nursing leadership

At day 90, I'd present a short review: what changed, what it cost, what's next, and the one-year roadmap (appendix).

How I'd build trust along the way

- **Credit the team's existing work** before proposing changes. Most fixes start from something someone already built.
- **Bring bad news early and in person.** The compliance number is going to drop when the definition changes. The compliance officer hears that from me first, with the explanation, not from a dashboard.
- **Be specific about what I don't know.** In the diagnosis, every "this looks wrong" comes with how I'd check it.
- **Keep the promises small enough to keep.** Three priorities, not ten.

Risks to the plan

Risk	What I'd do
A compliance deadline lands in the first 60 days	Support the campaign first; push the diagnosis back two weeks
Stakeholders resist a lower compliance number	Show the old and new side by side for one cycle, with the bridge from case study A
The team is stretched thin	Retiring reports and adding intake rules come before any new project
Data access takes weeks to grant	Request it on day one; use published reports in the meantime

Appendix: one-year learning analytics roadmap (LIB-48)

Quarter	Focus	Deliverables	Depends on
Q1 (days 1–90)	Trust the numbers	Metric definitions v1.0; pre-publication checks; access review; report rationalization	Data access; compliance office agreement
Q2	Make it routine	Data-quality checks automated and scheduled; governed weekly view (LIB-03) live; certification requirements matrix by role	Q1 definitions; HR role data
Q3	Connect learning to outcomes	Onboarding redesign launched with its staggered rollout; first look at leading indicators; certification currency measured (M6)	Measurement plan signed off; Q2 matrix
Q4	Decide with evidence	Month-6 onboarding decision; agency conversion pilot reviewed with the model from case study C; year-two plan	Q3 data; finance partnership

Quick wins inside the year: the governed compliance number (Q1), retiring unused reports (Q1), and the first automated data-quality report (Q2).

What the roadmap leaves out on purpose: a new LMS. A platform change should follow a year of clean definitions and known requirements, not precede them. When it comes, the scorecard in LIB-45 is how I'd run it.

Why it's built this way

The first month is for listening and tracing where the numbers come from, because a new director's early credibility depends on not being wrong about how things work. Priorities come from the diagnosis, and there are three of them, so each gets finished. The early wins are chosen because they're visible, cheap, and build the base for everything after: a trusted number, controls, and less noise. The roadmap puts measurement before platform change, because most of what a new platform promises depends on definitions and data quality the organization doesn't have yet.

Format: PDF, generated from this page. A one-slide version of the appendix (LIB-48) will be generated from the same table in the site build.

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